



PUBLIC SCHOOL IN-PERSON BOOK FAIR CHECKLIST

Your step-by-step guide to a successful in-person book fair

STEP 1

You Did It!



Choose Ignatius Book Fairs and set your fair dates

You've already accomplished this step! Check out our [Resources](#) throughout this guide.

STEP 2



Design Your Book Fair Experience



Give your school community advance notice of the book fair schedule so they can plan their visit



Share the [Backpack Flyer](#) the week before your fair opens



Keep your fair open one or more evenings and/or over the weekend

Consider hosting an evening event with snacks, beverages, and socializing



Consider being open all weekend and inviting people outside your school — be creative with your events!



Extend advertising to homeschoolers, co-ops, and families at neighboring schools

STEP 3



Recruit Volunteers



Create an online sign-up using a free service like [SignUpGenius](#)



Recruit volunteers to help with: promoting the fair within the school, unboxing and setup, scanning in boxes, decorating the space, working the floor suggesting books, running the check-out station, organizing refreshments for evening/weekend events, running a craft table for kids, promoting on social media, and packing up

STEP 4**Set Up Your Space**

- ☐ Arrange tables away from walls in a space of at least 800 sq ft
- ☐ Plan for 12–16 six-foot tables (or equivalent):

Early Readers	1 table	●
Picture Books	2–3 tables	● ● ●
Elementary Books	3 tables	● ● ●
Middle School Books	1–3 tables	● ● ●
Seasonal Books	1 table	●
Crafts & Activities	1 table	●
Comic Books	1 table	●
Older Readers & Adults	1 table	●
Toys & Trinkets	1 table	● ●
Check-out Station	1–2 tables	● ●

- ☐ Plan additional tables for snacks/beverages or a **coloring page** station for younger kids
- ☐ Have on hand: bags for purchases, a cashbox for cash sales, a Sharpie, packing tape

STEP 5**Calendars & Scheduling**

- ☐ Add fair details (times, dates, location) to all necessary school calendars
- ☐ Use our **Advertising Resources** for help with graphics

STEP 6**Advertise Early & Often**

- ☐ Post a Save-the-Date announcement 4–6 weeks before the fair
- ☐ Advertise weekly leading up to opening day using our **Advertising Resources**
- ☐ During the fair, post photos of what's available
- ☐ Before the last day, remind your community of their last chance to shop
- ☐ Places to advertise: school bulletin, calendar, and email list; announcement at school and public events; school newsletter from the principal or coordinator; school website, Facebook, Instagram, X; library flyers; announcements to homeschoolers, co-ops, and area schools; neighborhood paper

STEP 7**Watch Our Training Workshop**

- ☐ Watch our workshop video series featuring task-specific topics to keep you on pace:
Part 1 • Part 2
- ☐ Invite your volunteer team to watch along

STEP 8**Receive Your Book Fair Supplies**

- ☐ One week before your fair, we deliver: all books and items for sale, 2 payment devices, table category signs in acrylic frames, 50 book stands, colorful tablecloths (mint, yellow, orange), and 5 decorative posters. Add your own flair with seasonal themes, student art, balloons, or twinkle lights!

STEP 9**Delivery & Set-Up**

- ☐ Confirm receipt of 20–38 boxes delivered one week before your fair
- ☐ Find the box marked **Open First** — plug in payment devices to charge
- ☐ Find the marketing box and set up tablecloths, category signs, and book stands
- ☐ Log in to the payment device with your unique code and scan in the boxes
For POS device instructions, click [here](#)
- ☐ Sort boxes by category, place in front of corresponding tables, and unbox
- ☐ Arrange books for maximum viewing — bring tables away from walls

Advertising Schedule

- ☐ **6 weeks before:** Post **Save the Date** on all social media, school bulletin, and newsletter
- ☐ **5 weeks before:** Share **this video** on social media; include **sign-up link** for parents to create accounts
- ☐ **4 weeks before:** Post another Save the Date reminder with **this graphic**
- ☐ **3 weeks before:** Highlight select titles your staff or teachers enjoy; explain how sales benefit the school
- ☐ **2 weeks before:** Have principal send an invitation to the community with fair schedule
- ☐ **1 week before:** Set out **Sneak Peek flyers** in common areas and school newsletter
- ☐ **Evening before:** Post **kickoff graphic** on social media

Videos: [How to Create a Parent Account](#) • [How Orders Benefit Your School](#)

During the Fair (Daily Posts)

- ☐ **Day 1:** Kick off with a reading challenge: commit to setting aside dedicated family reading time
- ☐ **Day 2:** Post **this graphic**; remind community about in-person times/location + **online ordering**
- ☐ **Day 3:** Share reading recommendations by age and grade level
- ☐ **Day 4:** Share the top 5 most popular titles so far
- ☐ **Day 5:** Encourage "Stop, Drop and Read" — 20 min daily family reading habit
- ☐ **Day 6:** Thank everyone; ask parents to share their favorite picks
- ☐ **Day 7:** Last day — final reminder that purchases earn rewards back for the school

FINAL



Have a Wonderful Book Fair!

Reach out to your Book Fair Manager if any issues arise — we're here to cheer you on and give you advice and support along the way!